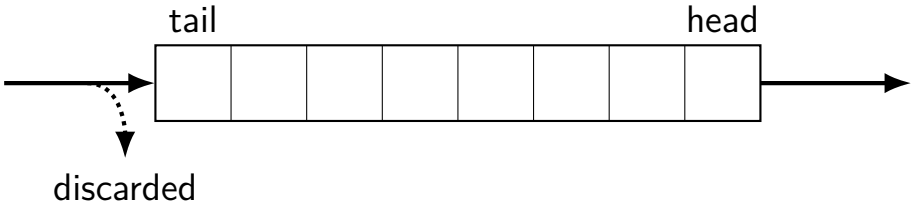
FIFO + drop-tail

scheduling policy: first-in first-out (FIFO)

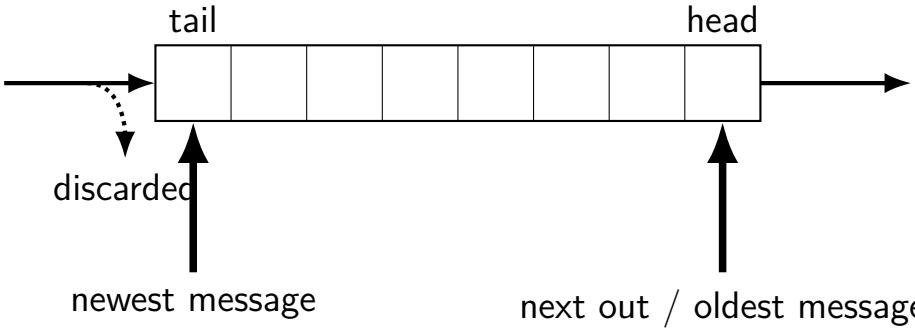
drop policy: drop tail



FIFO + drop-tail

scheduling policy: first-in first-out (FIFO)

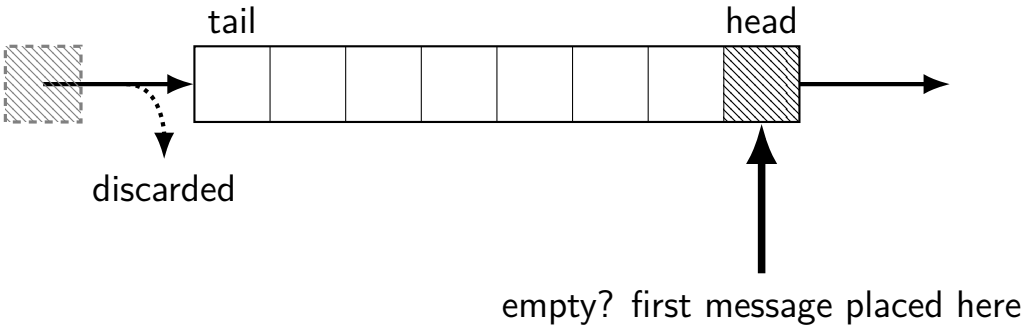
drop policy: drop tail



FIFO + drop-tail

scheduling policy: first-in first-out (FIFO)

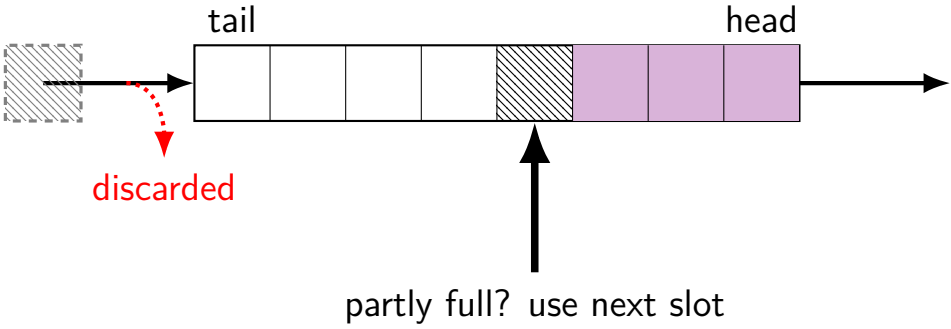
drop policy: drop tail



FIFO + drop-tail

scheduling policy: first-in first-out (FIFO)

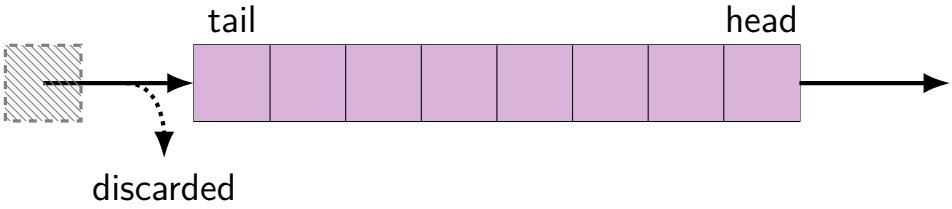
drop policy: drop tail



FIFO + drop-tail

scheduling policy: first-in first-out (FIFO)

drop policy: drop tail



full? discard new packets

queue scheduling

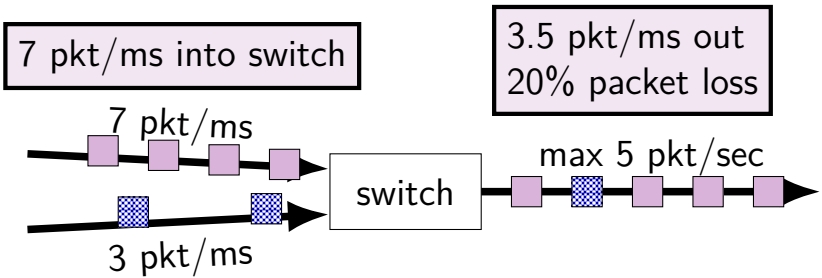
"what goes out on network first?"

simple policy: first-in, first-out (FIFO)

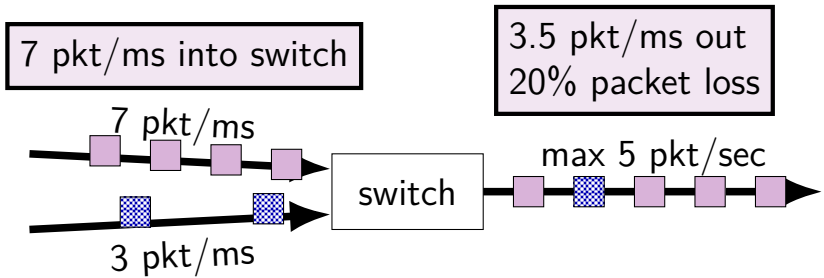
FIFO minimizes per-packet average latency, but...

doesn't distinguish between different flows

unfair dequeue/drop

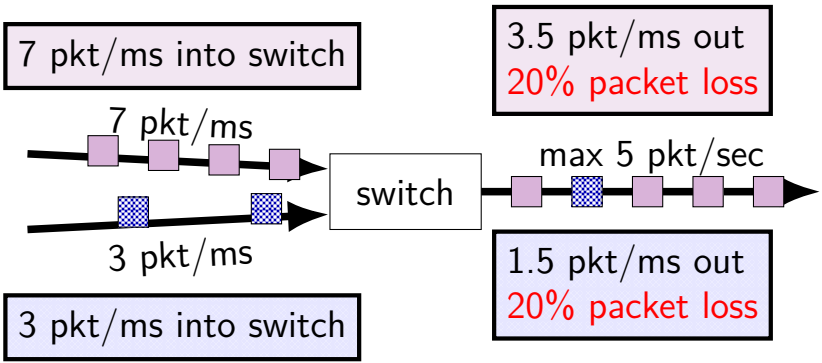


unfair dequeue/drop



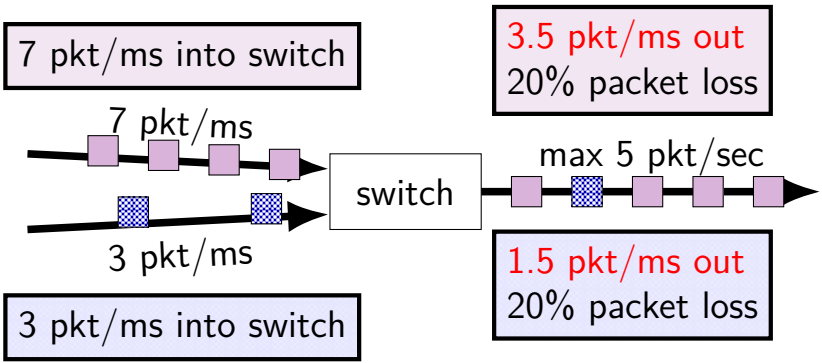
intuitive notion of 'fair' would mean:
top flow gets 2.5 pkts/sec out
bottom flow gets 2.5 pkts/sec out

unfair dequeue/drop



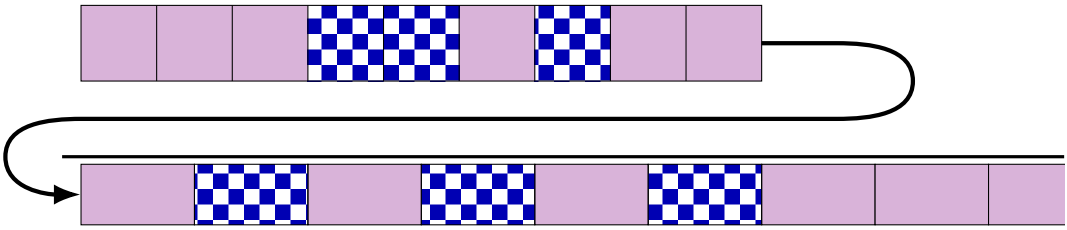
FIFO + drop-tail does not distinguish flows so both flows have same drop rate

unfair dequeue/drop

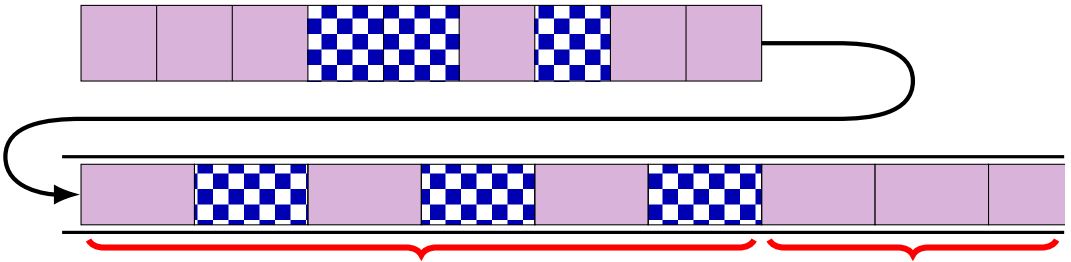


preserve ratio of input demand
far from even ('intuitive fair') split

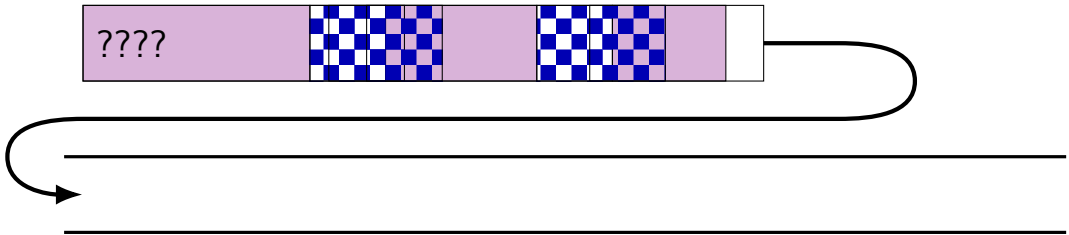
fair (de)queuing



fair (de)queuing



problem 1: variable packet size



just alternating packets doesn't work with variable sizes

need to send more packets from flows with faster packets

problem 2: packets arriving late

time =	queue	
	A1, B1, B2, B3	
0.0	B1, B2, B3	start sending A1
1.0	B1, B2, B3	finish sending A1
1.0	B2, B3	start sending B1
2.0	B2, B3	finish sending B1
2.0	B3	start sending B2
2.1	B3, A2	receive A2
2.9	B3, A2, A3	receive A3
3.0	B3, A2, A3	finish sending B2

problem 2: packets arriving late

time =	queue	
	A1, B1, B2, B3	
0.0	B1, B2, B3	start sending A1
1.0	B1, B2, B3	finish sending A1
1.0	B2, B3	start sending B1
2.0	B2, B3	finish sending B1
2.0	B3	start sending B2
2.1	B3, A2	receive A2
2.9	B3, A2, A3	receive A3
3.0	B3, A2, A3	finish sending B2

flow A missed a turn because packet was just a little late

intuition: should get extra turn to make up for this?

theoretical model: alternating bit

let's say we can split up packets into individual bits

fair sharing:
one bit from A, one bit from B, one bit from A, one bit from B, one bit from A, etc.

preview:

figure out what timing would look like if we could do this

use this timing to decide what packets to send
(the way we can actually send packets)

alternating bit ordering

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), A3 (2 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit)

step	—
1	send A1 bit 1
2	send B1 bit 1
3	send A1 bit 2
4	send B1 bit 2
5	send A2 bit 1
6	send B1 bit 3
7	send A3 bit 1
8	send B1 bit 4
9	send A3 bit 2
10	send B2 bit 1

alternating bit ordering

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), A3 (2 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit)

step	—
1	send A1 bit 1
2	send B1 bit 1
3	send A1 bit 2
4	send B1 bit 2
5	send A2 bit 1
6	send B1 bit 3
7	send A3 bit 1
8	send B1 bit 4
9	send A3 bit 2
10	send B2 bit 1

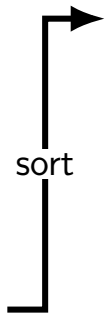
packet	finish step
A1	3
A2	5
A3	9
B1	8
B2	10

alternating bit ordering

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), A3 (2 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit)

step	—
1	send A1 bit 1
2	send B1 bit 1
3	send A1 bit 2
4	send B1 bit 2
5	send A2 bit 1
6	send B1 bit 3
7	send A3 bit 1
8	send B1 bit 4
9	send A3 bit 2
10	send B2 bit 1

packet	finish step
A1	3
A2	5
A3	9
B1	8
B2	10



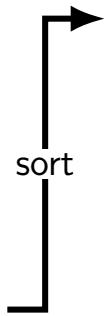
packet	finish step
A1	3
A2	5
B1	8
A3	9
B2	10

alternating bit ordering

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), A3 (2 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit)

step	—
1	send A1 bit 1
2	send B1 bit 1
3	send A1 bit 2
4	send B1 bit 2
5	send A2 bit 1
6	send B1 bit 3
7	send A3 bit 1
8	send B1 bit 4
9	send A3 bit 2
10	send B2 bit 1

packet	finish step
A1	3
A2	5
A3	9
B1	8
B2	10



packet	finish step
A1	3
A2	5
B1	8
A3	9
B2	10

using this order

computed the order packets “should” be received in

goal: achieve same order but without bit-by-bit

...by sending packets in desired receive order

full packet and ordering

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), A3 (2 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit)

bit-by-bit time

packet	finish at
A1	3
A2	5
B1	8
A3	9
B2	10

full packet and ordering

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), A3 (2 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit)

bit-by-bit time

packet	finish at
A1	3
A2	5
B1	8
A3	9
B2	10

whole-packet schedule

step=	
1	start sending A1
2	A1's last bit
3	start sending A2
3	A2's last bit
4	start sending B1
7	B1's last bit
8	start sending A3
9	A3's last bit
10	start sending B2
10	B2's last bit

full packet and ordering

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), A3 (2 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit)

bit-by-bit time

packet	finish at
A1	3
A2	5
B1	8
A3	9
B2	10

whole-packet schedule

step=	
1	start sending A1
2	A1's last bit
3	start sending A2
3	A2's last bit
4	start sending B1
7	B1's last bit
8	start sending A3
9	A3's last bit
10	start sending B2
10	B2's last bit

actual time

packet	finish at
A1	2
A2	3
B1	7
A3	9
B2	10

uneven finishing

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit), C1 (2 bit)

step	—
1	send A1 bit 1
2	send B1 bit 1
3	send C1 bit 1
4	send A1 bit 2
5	send B1 bit 2
6	send C1 bit 2
7	send A2 bit 1
8	send B1 bit 3
9	send B1 bit 4
10	send B2 bit 1

packet	finish step
A1	4
C1	6
A2	7
B1	9
B2	10

uneven finishing

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit), C1 (2 bit)

round	step	—
1	1	send A1 bit 1
1	2	send B1 bit 1
1	3	send C1 bit 1
2	4	send A1 bit 2
2	5	send B1 bit 2
2	6	send C1 bit 2
3	7	send A2 bit 1
3	8	send B1 bit 3
4	9	send B1 bit 4
5	10	send B2 bit 1

packet	finish step	finish round
A1	4	2
C1	6	2
A2	7	3
B1	9	4
B2	10	5

rounds / virtual time

alternating bit:

several rounds where we transmit 1 bit from each pending flow

can think of round number as a weird notion of time

"virtual clock" that advances at variable speed

called *virtual time*

rounds / virtual time

alternating bit:

several rounds where we transmit 1 bit from each pending flow

can think of round number as a weird notion of time

"virtual clock" that advances at variable speed

called *virtual time*

can quickly compute virtual time packet should finish

enough to tell us when to send each packet

computing virtual time

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit), C1 (2 bit)

'current' virtual time = 0

packet	virtual finish time

virtual time = time for packet alone + max {last finish time from flow, current time}

computing virtual time

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit), C1 (2 bit)

'current' virtual time = 0

packet	virtual finish time
A1	2 (= current + size)

virtual time = time for packet alone + max {last finish time from flow, current time}

computing virtual time

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit), C1 (2 bit)

'current' virtual time = 0

packet	virtual finish time
A1	2 (= current + size)
A2	3 (= A1's time + size)

virtual time = time for packet alone + max {last finish time from flow, current time}

computing virtual time

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit), C1 (2 bit)

'current' virtual time = 0

packet	virtual finish time
A1	2 (= current + size)
A2	3 (= A1's time + size)
B1	3 (= current + size)

virtual time = time for packet alone + max {last finish time from flow, current time}

computing virtual time

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit), C1 (2 bit)

'current' virtual time = 0

packet	virtual finish time
A1	2 (= current + size)
A2	3 (= A1's time + size)
B1	3 (= current + size)
B2	4 (= B1's time + size)

virtual time = time for packet alone + max {last finish time from flow, current time}

computing virtual time

sending A1 (2 bit), A2 (1 bit), B1 (4 bit), B2 (1 bit), C1 (2 bit)

'current' virtual time = 0

packet	virtual finish time
A1	2 (= current + size)
A2	3 (= A1's time + size)
B1	3 (= current + size)
B2	4 (= B1's time + size)
C1	2 (= current + size)

virtual time = time for packet alone + max {last finish time from flow, current time}

late packets

sending A1 (2 bit), B1 (2 bit), B2 (2 bit)
and A2 (2 bit) but that arrives between steps 4+5:

vtime	step	—
1	1	send A1 bit 1
1	2	send B1 bit 1
2	3	send A1 bit 2
2	4	send B1 bit 2
3	5	send B2 bit 1
4	6	send A2 bit 1
4	7	send B2 bit 1
5	8	send A2 bit 1
6	9	send A2 bit 1

pkt	virtual finish time

late packets

sending A1 (2 bit), B1 (2 bit), B2 (2 bit)
and A2 (2 bit) but that arrives between steps 4+5:

vtime	step	—
1	1	send A1 bit 1
1	2	send B1 bit 1
2	3	send A1 bit 2
2	4	send B1 bit 2
3	5	send B2 bit 1
4	6	send A2 bit 1
4	7	send B2 bit 1
5	8	send A2 bit 1
6	9	send A2 bit 1

pkt	virtual finish time
A1	2 (= current + size)

late packets

sending A1 (2 bit), B1 (2 bit), B2 (2 bit)
and A2 (2 bit) but that arrives between steps 4+5:

vtime	step	—
1	1	send A1 bit 1
1	2	send B1 bit 1
2	3	send A1 bit 2
2	4	send B1 bit 2
3	5	send B2 bit 1
4	6	send A2 bit 1
4	7	send B2 bit 1
5	8	send A2 bit 1
6	9	send A2 bit 1

pkt	virtual finish time
A1	2 (= current + size)
B1	2 (= current + size)

late packets

sending A1 (2 bit), B1 (2 bit), B2 (2 bit)
and A2 (2 bit) but that arrives between steps 4+5:

vtime	step	—
1	1	send A1 bit 1
1	2	send B1 bit 1
2	3	send A1 bit 2
2	4	send B1 bit 2
3	5	send B2 bit 1
4	6	send A2 bit 1
4	7	send B2 bit 1
5	8	send A2 bit 1
6	9	send A2 bit 1

pkt	virtual finish time
A1	2 (= current + size)
B1	2 (= current + size)
B2	4 (= B1's time + size)

late packets

sending A1 (2 bit), B1 (2 bit), B2 (2 bit)
and A2 (2 bit) but that arrives between steps 4+5:

vtime	step	—
1	1	send A1 bit 1
1	2	send B1 bit 1
2	3	send A1 bit 2
2	4	send B1 bit 2
3	5	send B2 bit 1
4	6	send A2 bit 1
4	7	send B2 bit 1
5	8	send A2 bit 1
6	9	send A2 bit 1

pkt	virtual finish time
A1	2 (= current + size)
B1	2 (= current + size)
B2	4 (= B1's time + size)
A2	6 (= (current AKA 4) + size)

virtual time algorithm

track:

- virtual start time of last sent packet
- virtual finish time of last packet for each flow

on receive packet:

compute virtual start time of packet = max of

- virtual finish time from last packet in same flow
- virtual start time of last sent packet + adjustment for how much sent

compute virtual finish time of packet =

- virtual start time + packet size

when sending, send with lowest virtual finish time

controlled fairness

fair queuing says with 2 flows, each gets half bandwidth

maybe we have other goals:

flow A gets 80% of bandwidth

flow B gets 20% of bandwidth

controlled fairness

fair queuing says with 2 flows, each gets half bandwidth

maybe we have other goals:

flow A gets 80% of bandwidth

flow B gets 20% of bandwidth

instead of 1-bit at a time, imagine:

A sends 4 bits per round, B sends 1 bit per round

weighted fair queuing

change fair queuing to add 'weights'

say N bits takes N/weight rounds to send

virtual finish time = virtual start time + size/weight

instead of just + size

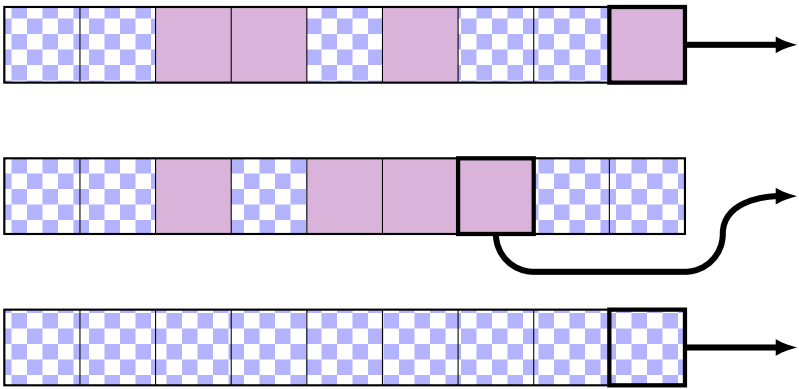
priority queue

assign priorities to flows

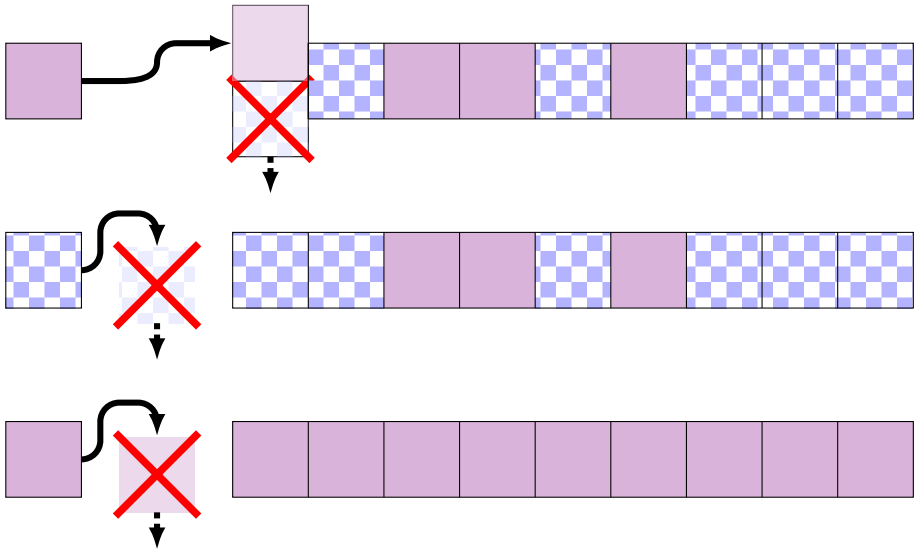
drop packet from lowest priority flow possible

on ties, choose other drop strategy

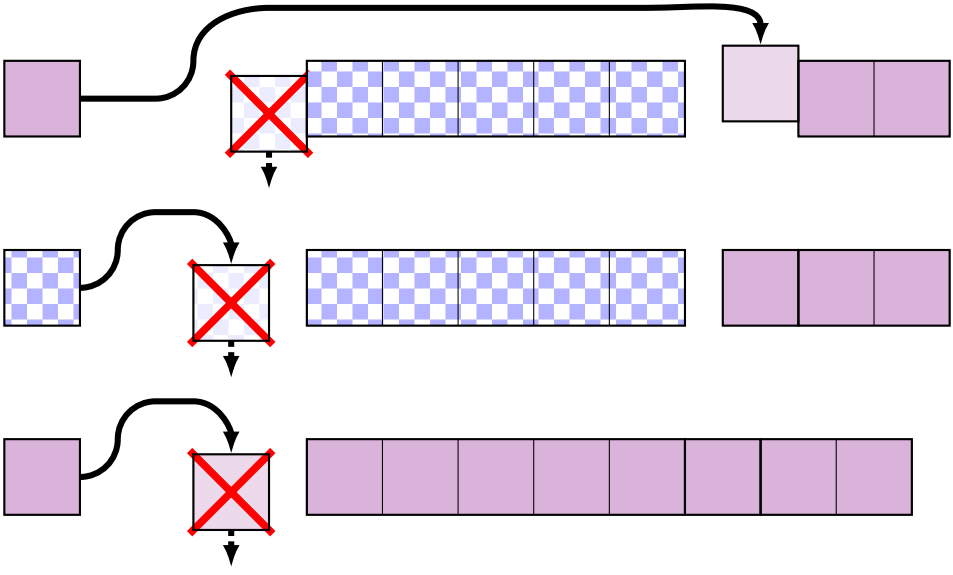
priority-based dequeue



priority-based dropping



priority-based dropping (alt)



priority: all or nothing

if flow A has greater priority than flow B

and both can use full available bandwidth

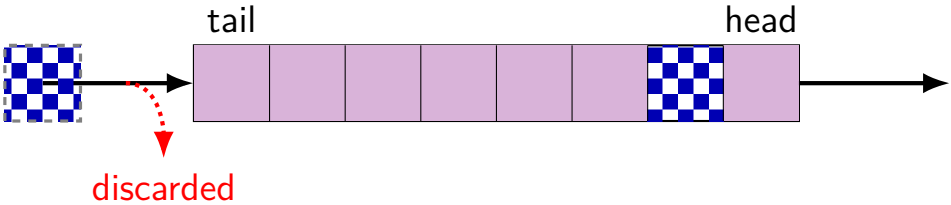
flow A gets full available bandwidth

flow B gets no bandwidth (everything dropped)

drop tail — unfair discard

drop tail is “unfair”

flow not responsible for most usage can be dropped

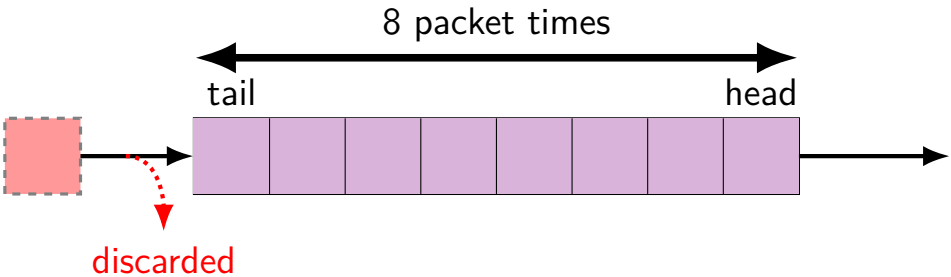


drop tail — long waits

switch now 'knows' flow is going to lose packet

but receiver won't know until packets in queue are sent first

might've been better to drop first packet



early detection

really want to drop earlier packets

- trigger congestion control to reduce send rate faster
- should reduce total number of dropped packets

but don't want to waste queue capacity

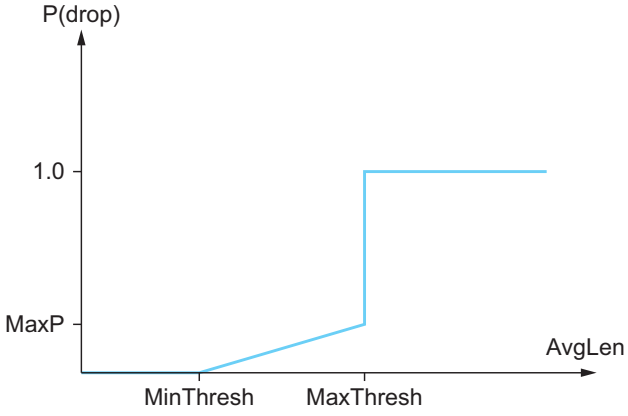
- (otherwise, just use smaller queue)

so drop 'some' packets early

random early detection (RED)

compute queue length

drop with probability based on queue length:

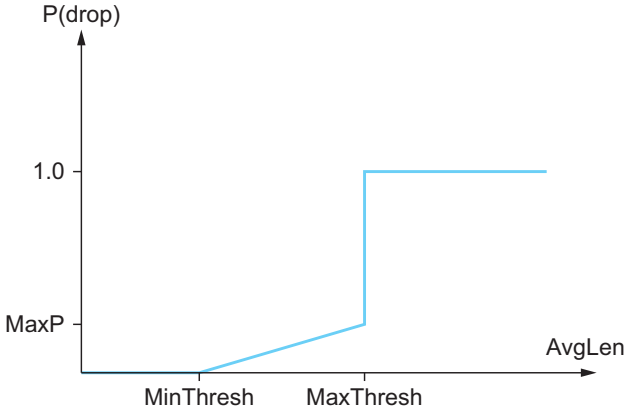


Peterson and Davie, *Computer Networks: A Systems Approach*, Fig 169 (sec 6.4)

random early detection (RED)

compute queue length

drop with probability based on queue length:



Peterson and Davie, *Computer Networks: A Systems Approach*, Fig 169 (sec 6.4)

measuring queue length

use moving average instead of actual value

reduce sensitivity to short ‘bursts’ of packets

spread packet-dropping ‘signal’ among all active connections

backup slides